

Staff Guide

Hibernation, Relocation and Evacuation Management



Resilience System Design and Alignment to Standards

This resilience system has been designed by Risk and Strategic Management, Corp (RSM), a specialist company expert in designing and implementing complex resilience strategies which protect people, facilities, assets, information, operations and organizational reputation. This system has been aligned to the following ISO and BSI standards to ensure it reflects the professional standards and practices of High Reliability Organizations: ISO 31000: Risk management; ISO 22317: Business impact analysis; ISO 22301: Business continuity management; ISO 22320: Emergency management; ISO 34001: Security and resiliency; ISO 22316: Organizational resiliency; and BSI 17091: Crisis management.

Introduction

This Guide has been developed as a self-help tool for staff in the event that a hibernation, relocation or evacuation [HRE] emergency situation occurs. The guidance provided in this document is not exhaustive and who you are, where you are, and what security and safety conditions you face will influence how you plan for, and respond to, an emergency situation.

The Guide addresses the needs of all staff, including local nationals and international staff, understanding that in some instances the guidance will be the same, while in other instances differences may occur.

This Guide has been provided to [insert country and activity name]:

Stage 1: Planning

ALL Staff

If you believe a hibernation, relocation or evacuation may be required you should start preparing ahead of the potential event, this can include:

- Withdrawing cash funds from your bank. It is advisable to both local and U.S. currency.
- Collect all important papers and documents, such as: passports, birth, marriage, divorce, and naturalization certificates, inoculation cards, insurance policies and bank books. You should seek to make electronic copies of all important paperwork.
- Prepare for each family member one suitcase [maximum 66lb.] containing: warm clothing, one pair of trainers or boots, underwear and socks/stockings, raincoats, one warm hat and one overcoat, eyeglasses and special medicines and food. Also, bring two blankets or a sleeping bag for each person. You should be ready to leave within 10minutes notice.
- Pack a limited supply of toys, games, books and snacks for your children.
- Maintain a full tank of gasoline in your vehicle. Consider buying a jerry can and having extra fuels for your vehicle.
- Store plenty of drinking water and canned or dry food in case you cannot leave your home or office for several days [ideally a minimum 3 days' supply].
- Have plenty of candles and at least two flashlights with spare batteries.
- Consider buying camping cookers or a BBQ set should the electricity or gas be turned off to your residence or office.
- Charge phones and computers as a means of communications – procure extra batteries and credit for mobile phones to ensure you can continue to communicate.

Hibernation, Relocation and Evacuation

- Ensure you have documents required for local travel stored and ready for a rapid departure.
- Monitor the local television and radio to track events and assess the situation.

International Staff

- Ensure you have all documents that may be required for international travel safely stored and ready for a rapid departure. Make electronic copies of these.
- If your current passport is not valid then contact your embassy immediately and seek a replacement or extension.
- Book flights in case you need to leave rapidly. Rolling or open tickets may be required.
- Make arrangements with local friends for the safekeeping of valuable items.
- If pets cannot be evacuated then make arrangements with local friends to care for them. If you cannot find care for them, leave them outside.
- Monitor the local media, Voice of America [VOA], Cable News Network [CNN] and the British Broadcasting Corporation [BBC] closely for announcements from the local government or the U.S. Embassy. The embassy will be closely monitoring the situation and will provide guidance as required to US nationals.
- If you are a United States national then ensure you are registered in the Smart Traveler Enrollment Program [STEP] program.

Specific Directions and Guidelines

Stage 2: Hibernation

ALL Staff

If you have implemented the hibernation protocol you should consider:

- Locking all doors and windows to the grounds and building.
- Moving to rooms away from those facing main streets.
- Do not leave the building unless it is safe to do so.
- Keep home or office lights low, especially on street facing windows.
- Monitor the radio and television to track events.
- Charge phones and computers to maintain communications should the power go off.
- Move vehicles and possessions indoors to secure them.
- Inform work colleagues and friends of your situation.
- Use texting should the power go off to extend the period you can communicate.
- Ensure you are prepared for a rapid departure.
- Conserve water and food resources.
- Plan different evacuation routes and inform other people of the actions you may take if you need to evacuate quickly.
- Confirm Safe Havens options with friends or work colleagues should you need to evacuate.

International Staff

- Book or hold flights and be prepared to leave while airports are still operating [confirm your plan with the management team].
- Consider land crossing point options should airports be closed.
- Inform the embassy of your personal details, status, and location.
- Track evacuation alerts and instructions from the embassy – *be prepared to follow these*.
- Prepare for a long-term departure from the country – preparing household effects, goods, and pets for a protracted absence.
- Gather critical work-related information and material and either email, carry or delete / destroy sensitive information.

Specific Directions and Guidelines

Stage 3: Relocation and Evacuation

ALL Staff

If the decision to relocate or evacuate has been made, you may need to consider:

- Implementing an evacuation quickly and while there is sufficient time to leave safely.
- Consider the dangers which may be presented along any routes used to evacuate.
- Inform someone of your plan and where you are going.
- Leave a note of your plan if communications are not working in an obvious place in your residence or office.
- Close all curtains, disconnect all appliances, turn off lights, lock your door and give your keys to a trusted person, with a copy of an inventory of personal items you are leaving behind.
- Proceed to the evacuation point without delay.
- If your automobile is not needed to reach the evacuation point, then leave it in the parking lot of your building or a safe location.
- Bring with you all important personal papers as well as one suitcase.
- Bring enough food [canned items, sandwiches, chocolate, and water] for each family member to last 2 to 4 days. Do NOT bring firearms or liquor.
- Leave your pets with neighbors. If you cannot take them with you, leave them outside.

International Staff

- Each individual is to have with them a 'Grab Bag' only. It is essential that the bag is no larger than a day sack, and that it does not contain any flammable items that may be considered "dangerous cargo" and could prevent you from boarding a flight.
- Consider the risks that may be along an evacuation route, or at a departure point [airport, port or border crossing].
- Inform the embassy and your management team of your plan and status.
- Inform a trusted person when you arrive at your destination.

Specific Directions and Guidelines

Personal Emergency Equipment

The following is recommended as a 'Grab Bag' list:

- Passport
- Visa
- Credit cards
- Money [cash]
- Medicines
- Glasses
- Communications
- Spare clothing
- Water
- Food
- Medical kit
- Flashlight [spare batteries]
- Laptop and flash drives
- Toilet paper
- Sleeping bag or blanket

Vehicle Emergency Equipment

If you are responsible for a vehicle then the following equipment should [ideally] be packed as part of a vehicle emergency equipment:

- Breakdown kit
- Tow rope
- Flashlight and batteries
- Spare engine oil
- Spare water
- Spare wheel
- Car jack
- Tire iron and locking wheel nut key
- Extra fuel
- Foot pump
- Maps
- A mobile phone and charger
- Warm clothing [cold weather conditions]
- Jump leads